Gaming Exp Rating Analysis (Report)



This Report Contains the Following:

- Executive Summary
- Introduction
- Methodology
- Data Visualizations
- Discussion

This Report is written on the Date (10/5/2026)

Executive Summary:

This Report contain the Analysis Result for **196 Games,** played in

6 years from (2020 to 2026), the overall average of my rating is **7.88,** across **20 Genres** of games from AAA and indie Titles, from **14 list** of rating pages and compare my taste in games compare to the critics as (IGN,Metacritic) and other players as (Steam).

Introduction:

This is a passion project build to answer the following Question:

1. What is the games genres that are more likely to enjoy?
2. Is it make a difference of the game AAA or indie?
3. Is my rate is effected by the critic's rate?
4. How does my rate compare to the recommendation rate of Steam players?
5. Does time affect my rating?

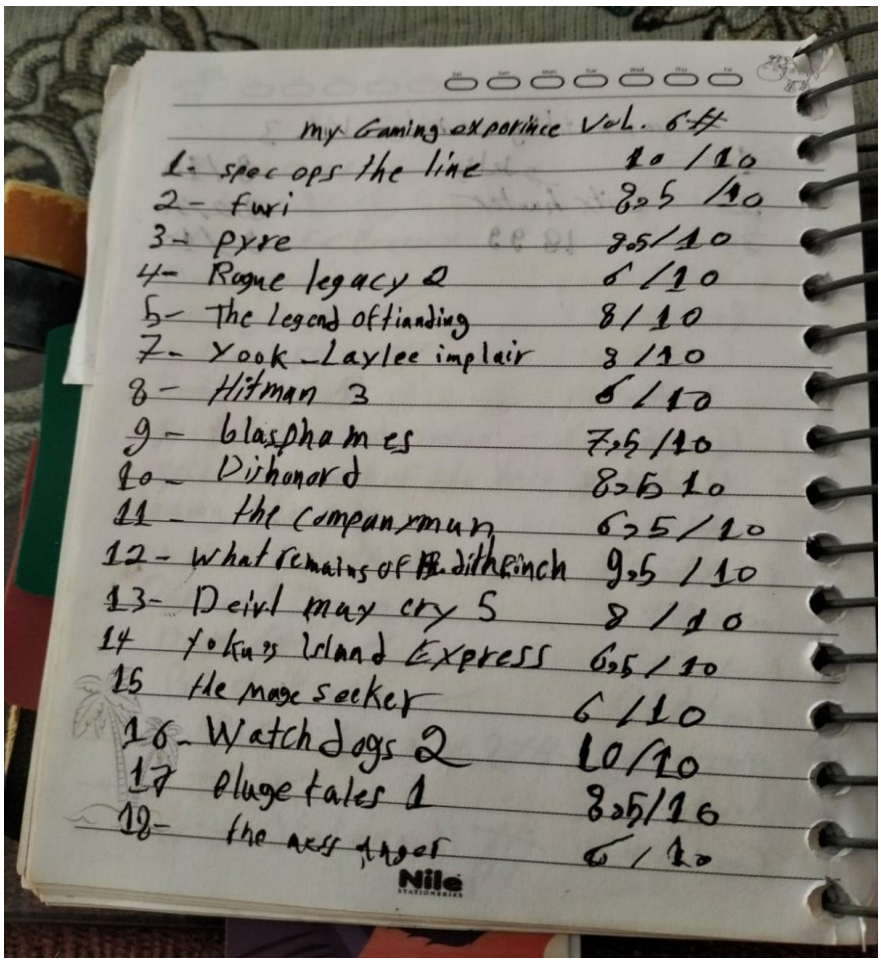
This tools used to help building this project:

- Google Sheets (Data entry, building the data structure)
- Microsoft Excel (connecting the data to the other tools to reflect the data recorded in google sheet to be up to date)
- Python (exploring the data and cleaning it)
- Power Bi (Data Visualization)

Methodology:

Dataset origin:

The dataset used in making this project originated from a page on the list written on paper



And use this data across 14 list and transform it with the power of data entry using Google sheets I build the dataset table

The dataset table contain the following columns:

- **Game number** (the game order from start of recording)
- **Game name**
- **Genres**
- **Type (**AAA or indie**)**
- **Year played**
- **Status (**Finished or not**)**
- **List vol.(**the paper list that recoded a set of game rating**)**
- **My_Rate(**based on the fun value I had with the game **)**
- **IGN Rating (/10)**
- **Steam Rating (/10)**
- **Metacritic Rating (/10)**
- **Avg_rating (**the average of my rating and ign, Steam,metacrtic)

MY_Rating_Game_Rank

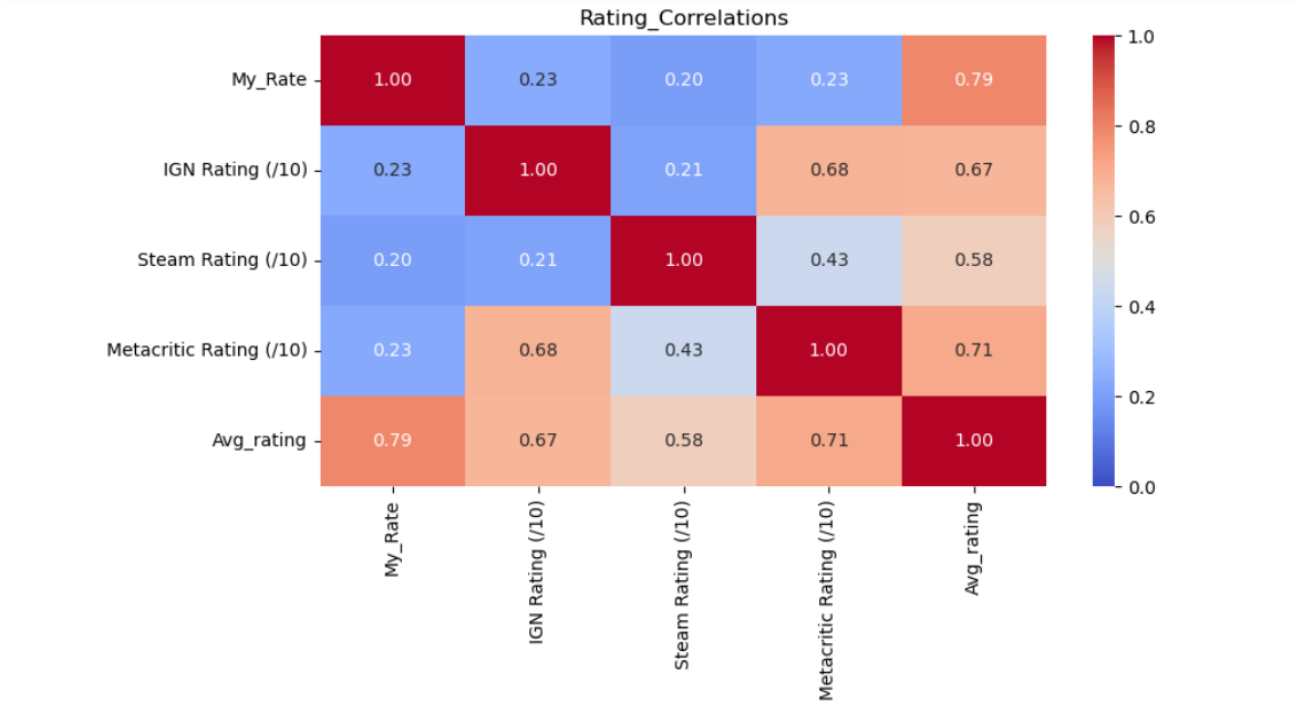
(Games bucket based on my rate of the game “10 = masterpiece
9 =< Excellent
8 =< Very Good
7 =< Good
5 =< Mediocre
4 =< Bad
3 =< Very Bad
1 =< Unplayable
”**).**

Game number	Game Name	Genres	Type	Year played	Status	List Vol.	My_Rate	IGN Rating (/10)	Steam Rating (/10)	Metacritic Rating (/10)	Avg_rating	MY_Rating_Game_Rank
22	The Adventure Pals	Adventure	inde	2020	Finished	2	5.1		9.2	7.8	7.4	Mediocre
23	The End is Nie	Platform	inde	2020	Unfinished	2	2.1		9.2	8.4	6.6	Unplayable
24	Finding Paradise	Story	inde	2020	Finished	2	10	9.1	9.7	8.1	9.2	Masterpiece
25	Assassin Creed Black Flag	Action	AAA	2020	Finished	2	10	8.5	8.8	8.4	8.9	Masterpiece
26	Monkey Island	Point-and-click	AAA	2020	Finished	2	5	8.7	9.5	8.6	8.0	Mediocre
27	sayonara wild hearts	Rhythm	inde	2020	Finished	2	10	7.9	9.6	8.4	9.0	Masterpiece
28	Luna and The Shadow Dust	Point-and-click	inde	2021	Finished	2	8	8	8.8	7.5	8.1	Very Good
29	Untitled Goose Game	Adventure	inde	2021	Finished	2	7.5	8	9.5	7.9	8.2	Good
30	Tomb Raider: Anniversary	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	2	9	7.8	8.1	8.3	8.3	Excellent
31	Grogoa	Puzzle	inde	2021	Finished	2	9	8.5	9.7	8.4	8.9	Excellent
32	Need for Speed Most Wanted 2	Race	AAA	2021	Finished	2	8	9	7.7	7.8	8.1	Very Good
33	Tourch Light 2	RPG	AAA	2021	Finished	2	8.5	9.1	9.2	8.8	8.9	Very Good
34	Amnesia: A Machine for Pigs	Horror	AAA	2021	Finished	2	8.5	8.3	6.8	7.2	7.7	Very Good
35	Roki	Puzzle	inde	2021	Finished	3	9	7.6	8.9	7.6	8.3	Excellent
36	The Rise of Tomb Raider	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	3	9	9.3	9.4	8.6	9.1	Excellent
37	3 out of 10 S1	Adventure	inde	2021	Finished	3	8.3			7.3	7.8	Very Good
38	Sindered	Adventure	inde	2021	Finished	3	8.5	7.8	7.9	7.4	7.9	Very Good
39	Solitairica	Roguelike	inde	2021	Finished	3	4.8		7.8	8.2	6.9	Bad
40	Hyber Drifter	Adventure	inde	2021	Finished	3	9	7.6	9.3	8.4	8.6	Excellent
41	Hitman Blood money	Stealth	AAA	2021	Finished	3	9.1	8	9.4	8.2	8.7	Excellent
42	Deponia the Complete Journey	Point-and-click	AAA	2021	Finished	3	8.2		8.4	7.5	8.0	Very Good
43	Deponia Domesday	Point-and-click	AAA	2021	Finished	3	6.1		8.4	7.6	7.4	Mediocre
44	Persona 4 Golden	Turn Based RPG	AAA	2021	Finished	3	5.9	9.3	9.7	9.3	8.6	Mediocre
45	Megaman x 5	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	3	8	7.5		7.6	7.7	Very Good
46	Megaman x 6	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	3	7.3	8		6.5	7.3	Good
47	Megaman x 7	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	3	4	6.7		5.8	5.5	Bad
48	Megaman x 8	Adventure	AAA	2021	Finished	3	9	7.3		6.8	7.7	Excellent
49	Deltarune	Turn Based RPG	inde	2021	Unfinished	3	10	9	9.8	8.6	9.4	Masterpiece
50	Night in the Woods	Adventure	inde	2021	Finished	3	5.6	8.7	9.4	8.8	8.1	Mediocre
51	Assassin Creed	Action	AAA	2021	Finished	4	9.3	7.3	7.6	8.1	8.1	Excellent
52	Alan Wake	Action	AAA	2021	Finished	4	9.5	9	8.9	8.3	8.9	Excellent

Exploration phase:

I needed Middleware which I found in Microsoft Excel connecting the data with its source in my google sheet file by using power query to make the data set up to date with its source, then I used python for exploring the data and know its shape to help me make insight to how to approach it in the visualization phase.

From this stage I discovered the relation between my rating and other parties rating



From this chart I concluded the following

1. My rate doesn't get effected by the critics rate nor Align with the other players rate from steam
2. IGN rating has a Moderate positive relationship Metacritic rating and a weak one with steam rating
3. While steam rate has Moderate positive relationship Metacritic rating

And from this result I answered two of the key questions of this project

- Is my rate is effected by the critic's rate?

  The Answer: no it doesn't because they has a week relationship

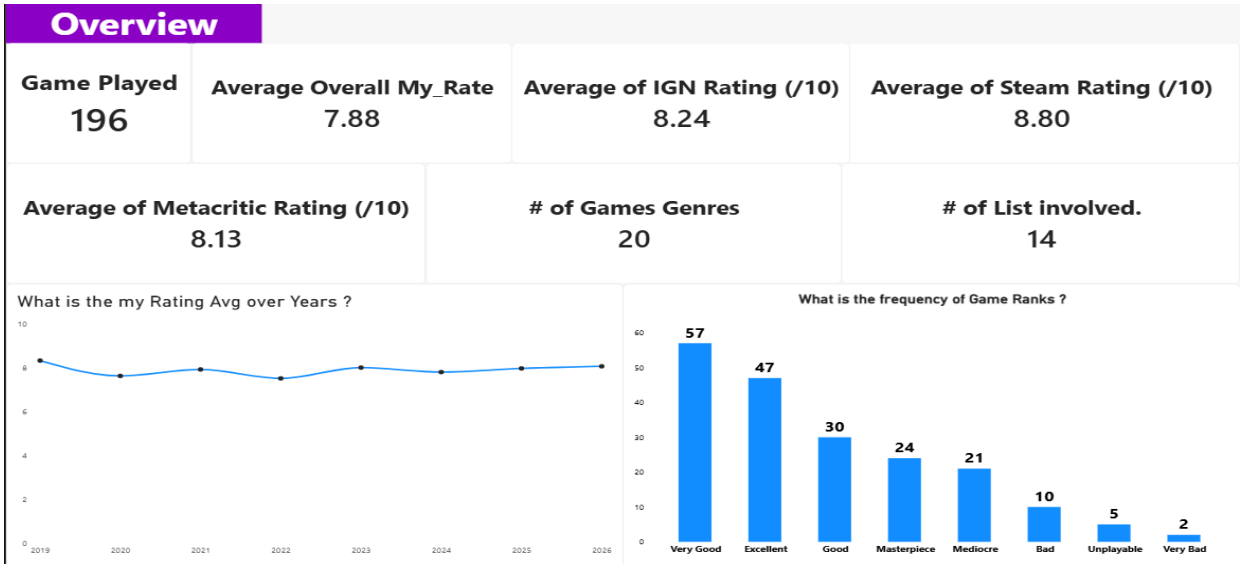
- How does my rate compare to the recommendation rate of Steam players?

The Answer: is no. This means that games with overwhelmingly positive or very positive Steam reviews still fail to bring me enjoyment

Data Visualizations:

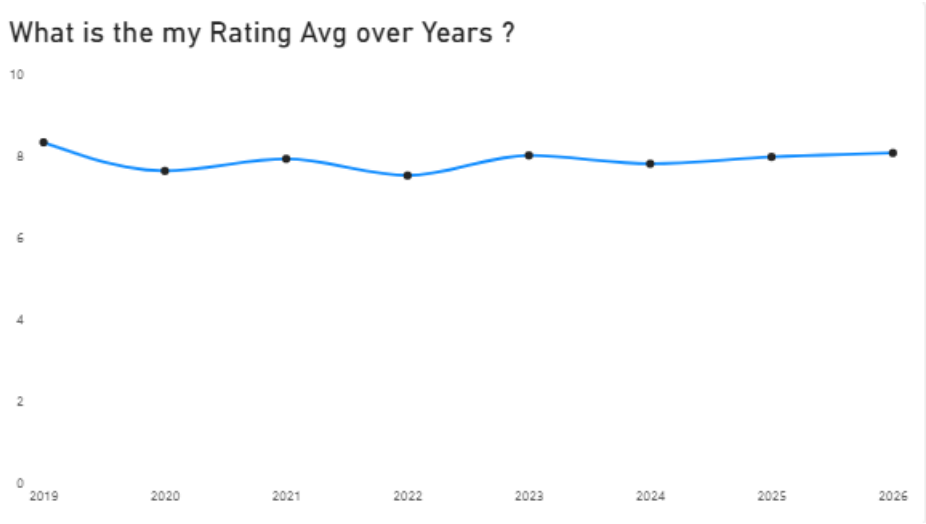
After importing the dataset from excel sheet to the Power Bi program and double check it with power query I created a four page Dashboard

1- Overview page

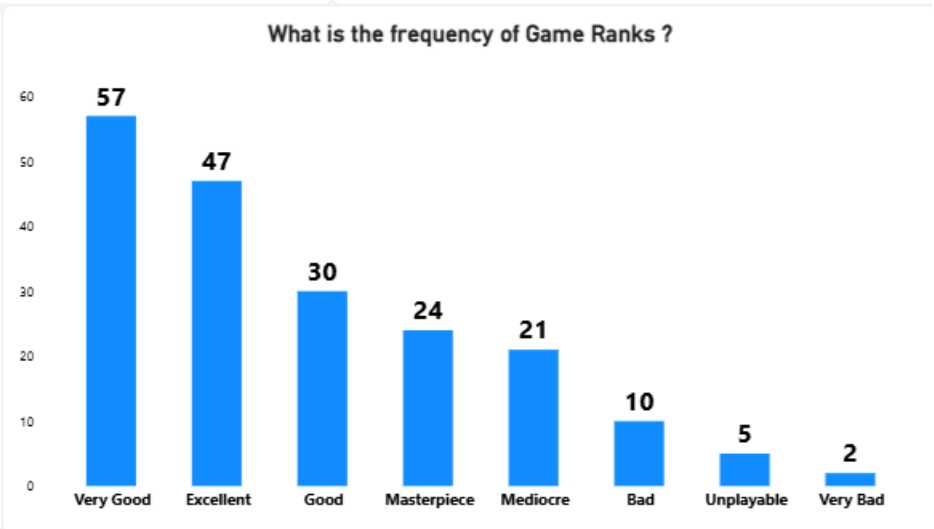


Contain the cards that reflect on the data in general by KPI metrics

And other two charts we will explain it briefly



This chart answers the **Does time affect my rating?** Question and shows that the Average of the game rating of the years don't differentiate that much and has close values

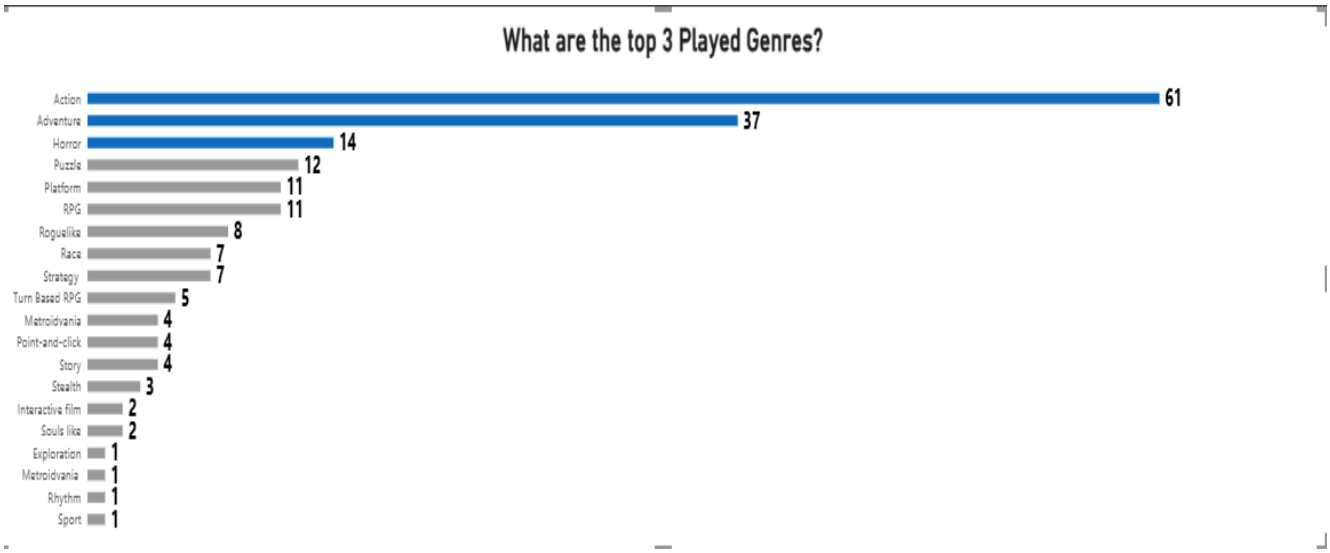


This one shows that most games falls in the Very Good Category

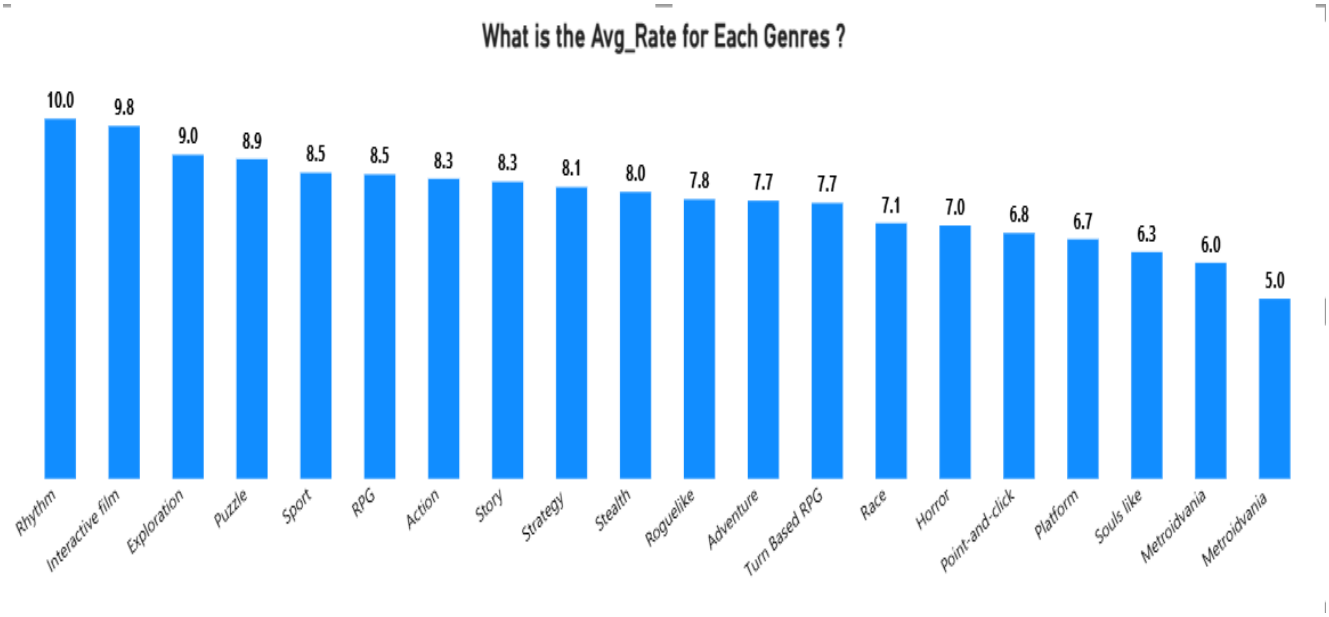
(8 =< Very Good) with **57 Games**, followed by Excellent games with **47 Games**, and **24 Games** in the Masterpiece Category which more than I expected

2- Genres Page:

Contains two chart one of them show the number of games played for each genres and the other displays the overall Average rate for each genres



This chart point out that the most played games genres is **Action with 61 Games**, followed by **Adventure with 37 games**, and then **Horror games with 14 games**, and from that I conclude that I have an orientation in choosing the games I play because the number of Action games varies from its closest genres by **24 games.**

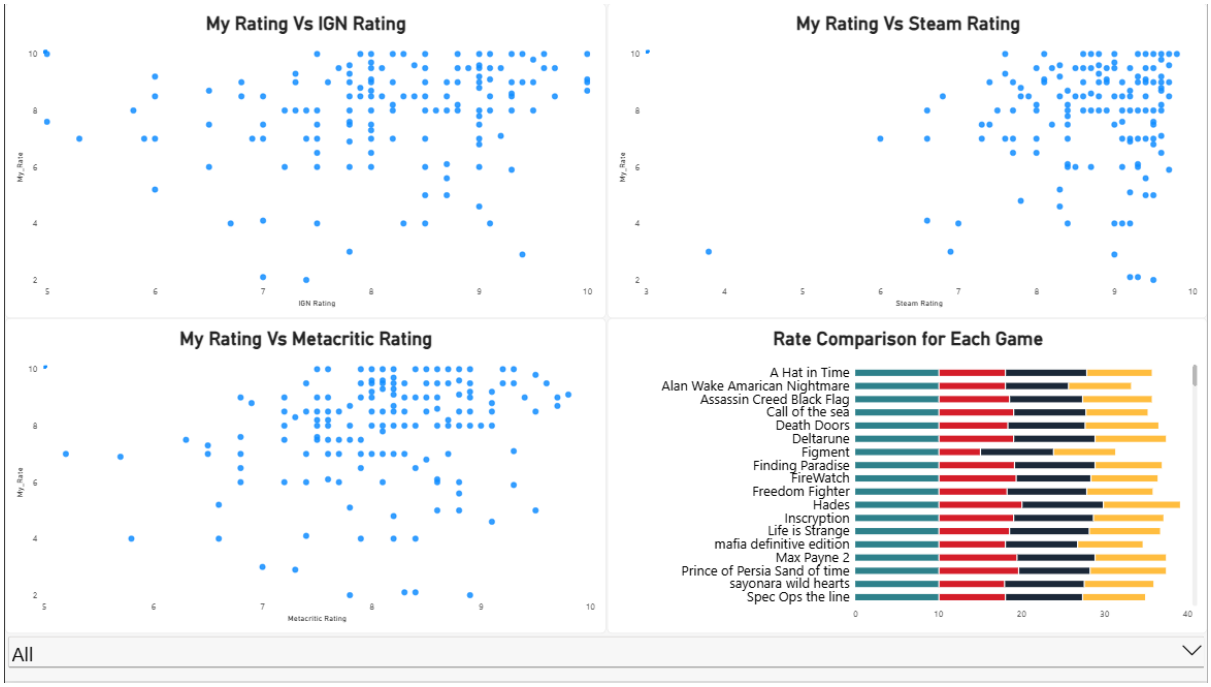


This chart on the other hand shows the average rate for each genres and point out that the top 3 genres by rate is **Rhythm games**, and **interactive film games** and **Exploration games**, and this chart could be misleading although it display correct information but not accurately because the number of games played for the top 3 genres present 2% from the games played

Because of that I will focus on the top 3 game genre played

- For Action games has **8.3 Avg_rate**
- For Adventure games has **7.7 Avg_rate**
- For Horror games has **7 Avg_rate**

3- Personal Rating Comparison Vs Others:



This page focus on comparing my Rate against IGN and Steam and Metacritic by using scatter plot chart to display the following

My Rating Vs IGN Rating:

- **Weak Correlation (0.23):** IGN scores are clustered tightly between (7.0 and 9.5), whereas my ratings span a much wider range (2.0 to10.0).

- **Key Takeaway:** I hold games to a more personal standard. A high score from IGN (8.5) doesn't guarantee that I will like it, as shown by several games IGN rated above 8.0 that I ranked below 5.0.

2. My Rating Vs Steam Rating:

- **Steam Score Concentration:** Steam user ratings are heavily skewed toward the top right (8.0 to 9.8), reflecting Steam's positive recommendation bias.

- **Key Takeaway**: While I agree on top-tier titles (upper-right cluster), I am far more critical of mediocre or flawed games than the general Steam community.

3. My Rating Vs Metacritic Rating:

- **Moderate Spread:** Metacritic displays a slightly smoother bell-curve distribution between 6.5 and 9.0 compared to Steam.

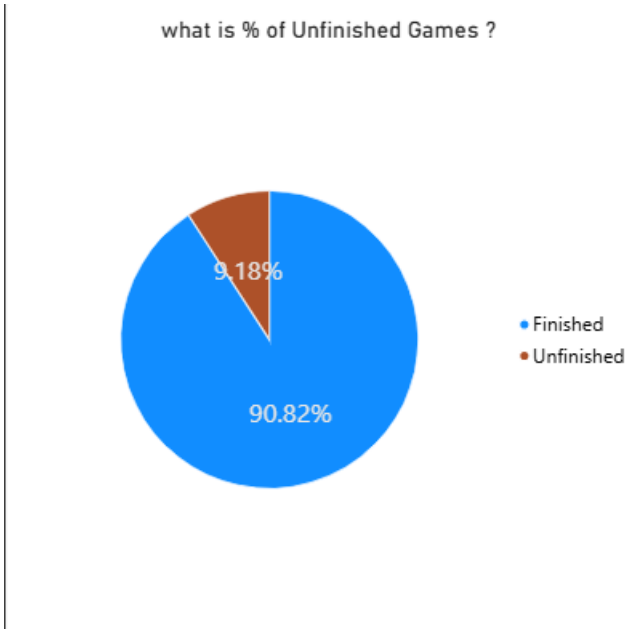
- **Key Takeaway:** Metacritic critic consensus aligns slightly closer to my ratting overall distribution, but outliers persist where critical consensus gave high marks to games I rated low (3.0–5.0).

For the forth chart I won’t explain it much it contain all the 4 rating alongside each other to compare it for every game

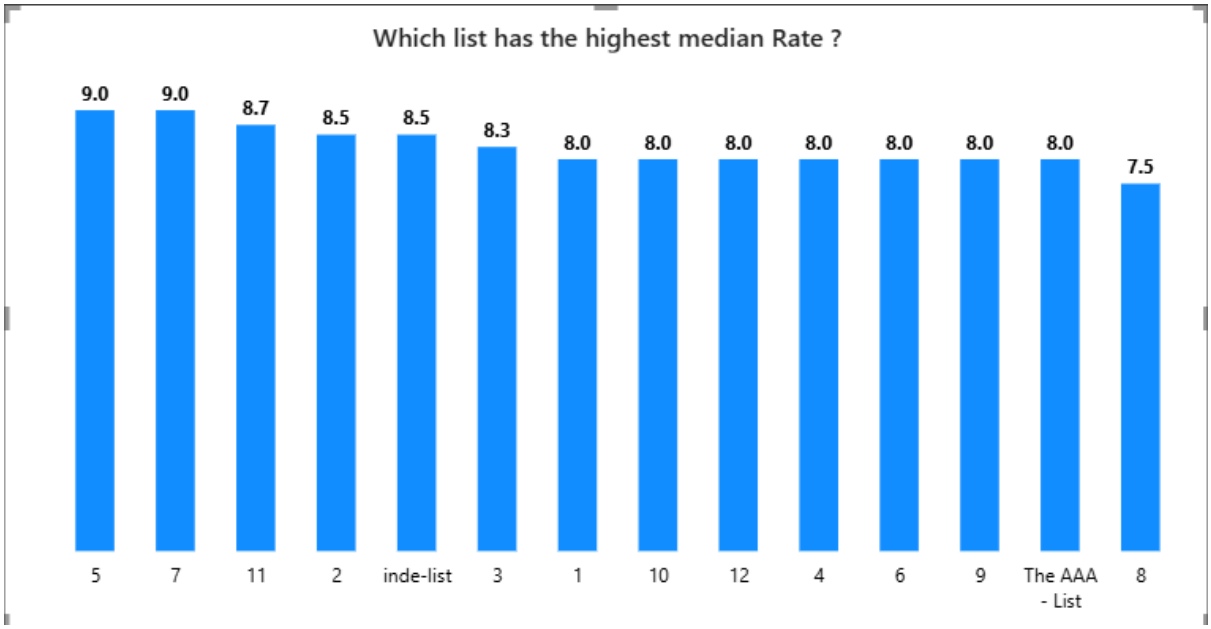
And the slicer in the bottom of the page is the genre to see is the genre make difference or not

4-Deep Dive:

This Page don’t focus on a specific topic but showcase a general information could complete the bigger picture, it contain 4 graphs

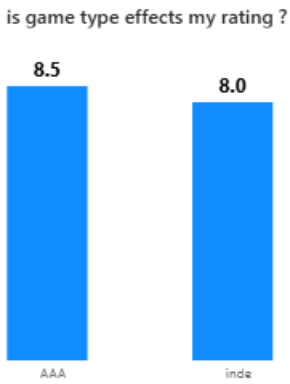


This graph clarify that the **% of the unfinished games is 9.18%**

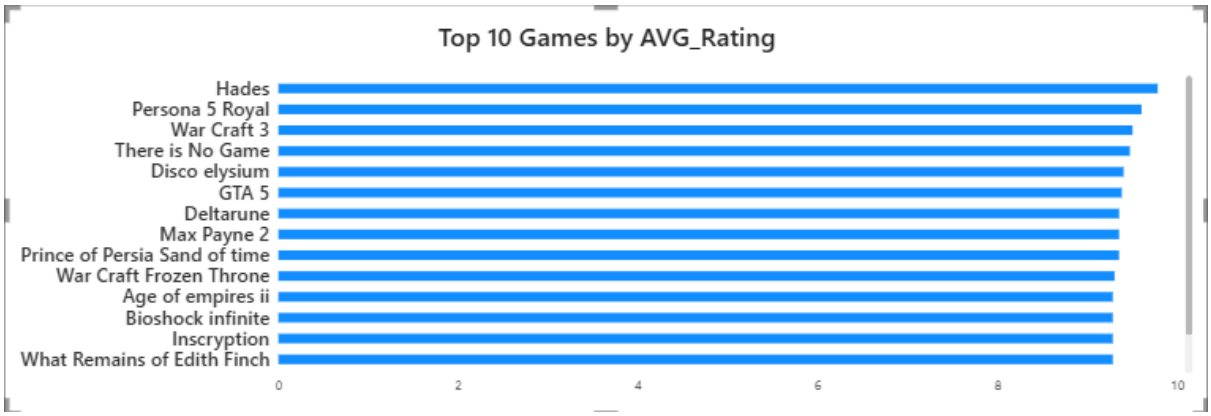


And that chart display the overall median of my Rate of the games of each list

From the information provided the median of my Rate of the lists is spread from **7.5 for the 8th** list to **9 for the 5th and 7th lists**



From this one I discovered that the game type don’t effect the rate of the game as long as the game is enjoyable, and that answer the question “*Is it make a difference of the game AAA or indie?*”



This chart showcase **the Goats** the games that top 10 by Avg-rate and Agreed upon from IGN and Steam players and Metacritic critic score

Discussion:

1. Synthesis of Core Findings & Research Questions

This project explored six years (2020–2026) of personal gaming data across 196 titles to uncover underlying preferences, rating behaviors, and external influences.

- **Independence from External Consensus:** The correlation analysis revealed weak positive relationships between My_Rate and major external platforms—IGN ($r = 0.23$), Metacritic ($r = 0.23$), and Steam ($r = 0.20$). While external platforms display tight clustering near high scores (IGN averages 8.24, Metacritic 8.13, and Steam 8.80), personal ratings span the full spectrum from 2.0 to 10.0. This confirms that critical acclaim or community "Overwhelmingly Positive" status does not guarantee personal enjoyment. Personal standards are driven by subjective experience rather than external hype or review scores.

- **AAA vs. Indie Preference:** Game classification plays a minimal role in rating outcomes, with AAA titles averaging an 8.5 rating and Indie titles averaging an 8.0. Enjoyment is driven by core gameplay mechanics and design execution rather than production budget or studio size.

- **Genre Dynamics and Potential Sample Bias:** Action (61 games) and Adventure (37 games) constitute the vast majority of titles played. While niche genres like Rhythm (10.0) and Interactive Film (9.8) yielded high average ratings, these sample sizes represent only ~2% of the dataset combined. Among high-volume genres, Action leads in satisfaction with an 8.3 average rating, followed by Adventure (7.7) and Horror (7.0).

- **Consistency over Time:** Average annual ratings remained exceptionally stable across the 2020–2026 timeframe (fluctuating tightly around the overall mean of 7.88). This indicates that personal evaluation criteria and enjoyment thresholds have remained consistent over time.

- **High Completion Rate:** A 90.82% completion rate across 196 games indicates strong selectivity in game choice, ensuring that most titles played are engaged with thoroughly before final assessment.

2. Analytical Limitations & Biases

To maintain analytical rigor, several limitations within the current dataset must be acknowledged:

- **Survivorship / Selection Bias:** Because games are selected based on interest or recommendations prior to purchase, the dataset is inherently skewed toward games expected to be good. This accounts for the high concentration in the "Very Good" (57 titles) and "Excellent" (47 titles) tiers.

- **Low Sample Size in Niche Genres:** Single-entry or low-count genres (e.g., Rhythm, Sport, and Exploration) skew top-level averages. Aggregating or bucketing secondary genres into broader parent categories would prevent statistical distortion in future analyses.

- **Lack of Playtime Metrics:** Rating games purely on a 1/10 scale omits the dimension of time investment. Incorporating "Hours Played" or "Cost-per-Hour" metrics would provide deeper context regarding game engagement versus overall satisfaction.

4. Actionable Insights & Recommendations:

1. **Refine Game Selection Criteria:** Stop relying on Steam user scores or critic reviews as primary filtering tools, given their low predictive value for personal enjoyment ($r \le 0.23$). Instead, focus selection on gameplay design traits found in top-performing Action and Adventure titles.

2. **Data Pipeline Enhancements:**
    - Automate data ingestion via Steam API or Metacritic web scraping to remove manual data entry steps between Google Sheets and Excel.
    - Normalize ratings into z-scores to allow direct percentile comparisons between personal ratings and critic distributions.
    - Add qualitative metadata tags (e.g., Art Style, Story-Driven, Mechanic Types) to enable granular sub-genre clustering beyond broad classifications like "Action" or "Adventure"